

understood the transition and the investors have been positive. If any of this had gone wrong, it would have been a difficult situation. Plus, in this industry, transitions have been painful.



What is unique about the positioning of your company?

When you speak of growth, there are really three strands to our DNA. First was the joint venture with British Telecom that gave us deep expertise in telecom with respect to OSS (operations support system) and BSS (business support system). Then, there was the Satyam acquisition. It provided a rich consulting background and great infrastructure on training and learning, plus a presence in diverse industries like auto, financial services, and manufacturing. Finally, there is the part on the other buyouts we have made such as Perigord [Life Science Solutions], a leader in medical packaging; and Com Tec Co [IT], a digital engineering firm with a focus on financial services.

Our [focus] is on organic growth from our largest clients and to deliver value. We believe there is a lot of headroom here.



How do you view the geopolitical challenges and the potential impli-

cations on business?

It is unbelievable that we had the pandemic first, followed by wars. I think there is a tendency to look at near-term downsides. Let's understand that this industry was sub-\$1 billion [by revenue] 25 years [ago]... [it is] \$250 billion now. Even the most conservative estimates suggest it will double at the very least in the next 10 years. There will be ups and downs, but we understand sectors deeply and run global-scale businesses. Our belief is [that] there is no reason for pessimism. Our Top 50 cus-

focus on technology has only increased. There is more awareness with boards spending more time on it. India's credibility is clearly established. Twenty years ago, it was about body shopping and today the relevance of the Indian model has increased. Apart from the Tatas, we are the only other player with other core businesses. Questions will always come up about the industry... [but] the long-term piece has been answered.

The centrality of technology to every industry is well-established. It

plus with software engineering and development historically, it has been like a bespoke card. The perception earlier was that there was a gigantic difference in skills between software developers but now as you start to use AI work benches, there will be an equalisation of capability.



How does one look at AI as that big opportunity?

For one, it is not an expense, and most clients intuitively understand how it will reshape the industry they are in.

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tomers have been with us for a decade, and they take a long-term view.



What is it that you like about what you are seeing in your industry now?

The relevance of technology and IT services has never been higher in India, nor have we seen a larger talent pool. This is one industry that was told it would not survive Y2K, the global financial crisis and Covid-19. It was constantly written off. But over time, the

is as important as what the internet did to every industry like retailers now getting to show a lot more of their product range. AI is a very big story and takes me to how banks adapted over time. In 2000, they spent 1% of their spend on technology and now, that is at 10%. With AI, it is not hard to imagine [the spend] being 50% 10 years from now. That dramatic reprioritisation is our opportunity.

We understand technology and how it applies in an enterprise context. Our role will be important,

Besides, it is a time of great disruption. While it is impossible to understand the configuration 10 years from now, some things will be very clear. While AI and, say, VR will take off, there will be a need for people to understand an industry deeply as much as a need to train or the need for people to bridge that techno-functional gap, which is technical knowledge plus industry-specific knowledge. If we work on all three, we will be fine. **BT**

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